03-04 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） The Secret Life of Ants

① When you see a line of tiny ants carrying a bread crumb across the kitchen floor, you may think they are simple little creatures. In fact, ants live in one of the most organized **societies** on Earth. A big ant nest can have **more than 100,000** members, yet almost no fighting happens inside. How is this possible?

② In every nest, ants are divided into three main groups with different jobs. The **queen** is the biggest ant. Her only job is to lay eggs — sometimes **over a thousand a day**. The **workers** are all female. They bring food, clean the nest, take care of baby ants, and fight enemies. A third group, the **males**, are small and have wings. They live only for a few weeks, just long enough to find a new queen in the summer sky.

③ Ants do not shout or use phones, but they "talk" in a very clever way — they **leave chemical signals**, called pheromones, along their path. When a worker finds sugar in a kitchen, she walks home and leaves a strong smell behind her. Other ants smell this trail and follow it, which is why ants often appear in a long straight line. When the food runs out, the last ant stops leaving the smell, and soon the line disappears.

④ Ant teamwork is really amazing. In Brazilian forests, there is a kind of ant called the **leaf-cutter ant**. Each worker cuts a small piece of green leaf, about twenty times her own weight, and carries it home. Back in the nest, other ants chew the leaves into soft soil and grow a special kind of mushroom — their main food. These ants, in a way, became farmers **40 million years** before humans did.

⑤ Not everything about ants is friendly, of course. Some ants keep other small insects like pets and "milk" them for sweet water. Some big nests fight real wars against their neighbours. But their busy, careful life teaches us one clear lesson: a small body is not a small idea. When thousands of little creatures work with a shared goal and a clear plan, they can build bridges out of their own bodies, move objects hundreds of times their size, and run a silent, successful city right under our feet.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What surprises the writer about a big ant nest?

A. It can move from place to place every week.
B. It has more than 100,000 members but little fighting inside.
C. It is always built on top of high trees.
D. It is usually controlled by male ants.

2. What is the main job of the queen ant?

A. Finding food for the nest.
B. Fighting enemies outside the nest.
C. Laying eggs inside the nest.
D. Cleaning the baby ants' room.

3. Why do ants often walk in a long straight line?

A. They are afraid of getting lost in the dark.
B. They follow the chemical smell left by the first ant.
C. They must walk behind the biggest worker.
D. They use the sun to find the way.

4. What is special about leaf-cutter ants?

A. They can speak to humans.
B. They live only in the desert.
C. They grow mushrooms as their main food.
D. They are the smallest ants in the world.

5. Which of the following best shows the main idea of the passage?

A. Ants are lazy and messy animals.
B. Ants hate humans and will attack them.
C. Ants live in a small but well-organized world of teamwork.
D. Ants need people's help to build their nests.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段末句 "more than 100,000 members, yet almost no fighting happens inside"
【解析】作者惊讶的是蚁巢有超过 10 万成员却几乎不打架。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段第 2 句 "Her only job is to lay eggs"
【解析】蚁后的唯一任务是产卵。其他三项均为工蚁的工作，张冠李戴。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题

【定位】第③段第 2—3 句 "leave chemical signals... smell this trail and follow it"
【解析】后续蚂蚁闻到信息素气味并沿气味行进，因此形成长排。A 项"怕黑"、C 项"跟大个工蚁"、D 项"靠太阳"均无依据。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段第 3 句 "grow a special kind of mushroom — their main food"
【解析】切叶蚁特殊之处在于把叶片嚼碎后培育蘑菇作为主食。A、B、D 均与原文矛盾或无依据。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑤段末 "a small body is not a small idea... silent, successful city right under our feet"
【解析】全文围绕蚂蚁小小身体却有高度组织的社会，突出"团队协作、井然有序"。A、B 与文意相反；D 属无中生有。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **pheromone** [n.] 信息素
- **leaf-cutter ant** 切叶蚁
- **crumb** [n.] 面包屑